

CAREER PREP

2026 & 2027 OFFICIAL RATING FORM

MIDDLE SCHOOL

Judges: Using minimal (1-4 points), adequate (5-8 points), or exemplary (9-10 points) performance levels as a guideline in the rating form, record the scores earned for the event criteria in the column spaces to the right. The X1 or X2 notation in the criteria column is a multiplier factor for determining the points earned. (Example: an "adequate" score of 7 for an X1 criterion = 7 points; an "adequate" score of 7 for an X2 criterion = 14 points.) A score of zero (0) is acceptable if the minimal performance for any criterion is not met.

Go/No Go Specifications

- Before judging the entry, ensure that the items below are present; indicate presence with a check mark in the box.
- If an item is missing, leave the box next to the item blank and place a check mark in the box labeled ENTRY NOT EVALUATED.
- If a check mark is placed in the ENTRY NOT EVALUATED box, the entry is not to be judged.

- ☐ Cover letter and job-specific resume submitted
- ☐ ENTRY NOT EVALUATED

COVER LETTER (40 points)				Record scores in the column spaces below.
CRITERIA	Minimal performance 1-4 points	Adequate performance 5-8 points	Exemplary performance 9-10 points	
Introduction (X1)	Introduction fails to describe the participant, and/or does not clearly identify the position or reason for contact, and/or does not indicate how the position was discovered, and/or does not indicate interest, and/or does not grab the employer's attention.	Introduction describes many of the elements (e.g., participant description, how the position was identified, reason for applying, etc.) and briefly addresses others (e.g., how the position was discovered, interest level, etc.), resulting in an adequate introduction.	Introduction incorporates all elements—the participant, the position or reason for contact, how the position was discovered, and genuine interest in the position—and ultimately grabs the employer's attention.	
Body (identification of skills) (X1)	Participant fails to identify any skills or qualifications, does not explain interest, and does not indicate how his/her skills would provide benefit to the company.	Participant indicates his/her skills, with a general explanation of how the skills relate to the position at hand; participant conveys interest, and briefly connects the skills to benefits for the company.	Participant provides one or two strong qualifications and clearly relates these skills to the job at hand; participant clearly explains how his/her interest and skills can benefit the company.	
Conclusion (X1)	The conclusion does not include a thank-you to the employer and/or, does not note contact information, is not assertive, and/or lacks mention of follow-up after a given period of time.	The conclusion may or may not include a thank-you and follow-up to the employer with contact information; overall, it is adequate.	The conclusion includes a thank-you to the employer for his/her time and the applicant's contact information; it is assertive and mentions a method of follow-up within a given period of time.	
Overall Writing Quality and Grammar (X1)	Writing does not make sense; participant has written too much or too little; there are multiple spelling and grammatical errors.	Writing is average and includes relevant information and content; it is somewhat convincing to an employer; there are minor spelling or grammatical errors.	Writing flows well, is clear, concise, and gets right to the point; it is convincing and contains no spelling or grammatical errors.	
COVER LETTER SUBTOTAL (40 points)				

JOB-SPECIFIC RESUME (40 points)				Record scores in the column spaces below.
CRITERIA	Minimal performance	Adequate performance	Exemplary performance	
	1-4 points	5-8 points	9-10 points	
Audience and Purpose (X1)	Resume does not address a particular audience; the purpose is not clearly stated; revision is needed.	Audience and purpose are generally implied; the resume is somewhat tailored to the employer.	Audience is clearly addressed and the resume is tailored to the employer; the purpose is clearly stated.	
Presentation and Format (X1)	Resume does not have a clear design format; headers are not used or are used incorrectly or inappropriately; resume does not use reverse chronological format.	Resume attempts (and partially succeeds) to use a reverse chronological format; headers are used for a somewhat professional and concise presentation.	Resume follows a reverse chronological format; it uses clear and appropriate headers to organize information; it has a professional appearance.	
Language and Style (X1)	Participant fails to use action words; phrasing is wordy and lacks focus.	Participant uses some action words and some concise and clear words in most of the resume.	Participant consistently uses strong, clear, and concise words throughout the resume.	
Overall Writing Quality and Grammar (X1)	Writing does not make sense; participant has written too much or too little; there are multiple spelling and grammatical errors.	Writing is average and includes relevant information and content; it is somewhat convincing to an employer; there are minor spelling or grammatical errors.	Writing flows well, is clear, concise, and gets right to the point; it is convincing and contains no spelling or grammatical errors.	
JOB-SPECIFIC RESUME SUBTOTAL (40 points)				

Rules violations (a deduction of 20% of the total possible points for the above sections) must be initialed by the judge, coordinator, and manager of the event. Record the deduction in the space to the right.

Indicate the rule violated: _____

PRELIMINARY SUBTOTAL (80 points)

SEMIFINAL MOCK INTERVIEW (50 points)				Record scores in the column spaces below.
CRITERIA	Minimal performance	Adequate performance	Exemplary performance	
	1-4 points	5-8 points	9-10 points	
Organization (X1)	Participant is unorganized and unprepared for the interview; an illogical explanation of the career choice is presented.	Participant is generally prepared for the interview; an explanation of the career choice is somewhat communicated and organized.	Interview responses are clear, well organized, and easy to follow; the responses reflect knowledge of the career choice and are communicated in a concise manner.	
Knowledge (X2)	Participant seems to have little understanding of the concepts in the career choice; answers to questions may be vague.	Participant exhibits a general understanding of the career choice.	Participant shows clear evidence of a thorough understanding of the career choice.	
Delivery (X1)	Participant is verbose and/or uncertain in the interview; participant's posture, gestures, and lack of eye contact diminish the interview.	Participant is somewhat well-spoken and clear in the interview; participant's posture, gestures, and eye contact are acceptable in the interview.	Participant is well-spoken and clear in the interview; participant's posture, gestures, and eye contact result in a polished, natural, and effective interview.	

SEMIFINAL MOCK INTERVIEW (50 points) – continued				
Articulation (X1)	Communication is full of illogical thoughts that lack clarity, and/or there is insufficient information provided about the career choice; leadership and/or 21 st century skills are not evident.	Communication is somewhat logical, easy-to-follow, and/or there is sufficient information provided describing the career choice; leadership and/or 21 st century skills are somewhat evident.	Communication is clear and concise, and there is ample information provided about the career choice; leadership and/or 21 st century skills are clearly evident.	
SEMIFINAL MOCK INTERVIEW SUBTOTAL (50 points)				
Rules violations (a deduction of 20% of the total possible points in the semifinalist sections above) must be initialed by the evaluator, coordinator, and manager of the event. Record the deduction in the space to the right. Indicate the rule violated: _____				
SEMIFINAL SUBTOTAL (50 points)				
To arrive at the TOTAL score, add any subtotals and subtract rules violation points, as necessary. TOTAL (130 points)				

Comments:

 I certify these results to be true and accurate to the best of my knowledge.
JUDGE

Printed name: _____ Signature: _____